

Property Investment Purchase Checklist — Queensland

Due diligence for buying an investment property, beyond what a homebuyer checklist covers.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only — not financial, tax or legal advice. Engage a qualified accountant, mortgage broker, and conveyancer before purchasing.

Section 1 — Structuring the Purchase

- ☐ ☐ **Decide on ownership structure before you buy** — individual, joint, trust, or company each carry different land tax, income tax, and asset-protection implications.
- ☐ ☐ **Understand Queensland land tax thresholds.** The threshold is **\$600,000 for individuals** and **\$350,000 for companies and trusts** — meaning trust/company structures are caught by land tax at a much lower value than individual ownership.
- ☐ ☐ **Understand the absentee owner surcharge.** Absentee individuals face a land tax surcharge (currently **3%**, having stepped up from an original 2%) on the value above the relevant threshold.
- ☐ ☐ **If you're a foreign entity, understand Additional Foreign Acquirer Duty (AFAD).** Foreign acquirers pay an additional **7% duty** on top of standard transfer duty for residential land — separate from any land tax foreign surcharge that applies annually while you hold the property.
- ☐ ☐ **Know that Queensland's foreign surcharge relief framework changed significantly for 2026-27.** From land tax liabilities arising on or after 30 June 2026, the previous ex gratia relief system for the land tax foreign surcharge is being replaced with a new administrative exemption framework, requiring new application forms from 1 July 2026 if you're seeking relief as a genuine commercial contributor or residential land developer — note that a foreign entity simply holding land passively as a landlord/investor generally does **not** qualify for this relief.
- ☐ ☐ **Get investment-specific finance pre-approval.**

Section 2 — Due Diligence on the Property Itself

- ☐ ☐ **Order a building and pest inspection** — just as essential for an investment purchase.
- ☐ ☐ **Review the Seller Disclosure Statement (Form 2) and prescribed certificates carefully** — mandatory since 1 August 2025, and just as relevant to your due diligence as an investor as it is for owner-occupiers.
- ☐ ☐ **If buying a body corporate property, review the records thoroughly** — sinking fund health, special levies, and any disputes directly affect your investment returns.
- ☐ ☐ **Research the local rental market specifically** — vacancy rates, comparable rents, and tenant demand for your target suburb.
- ☐ ☐ **Factor in climate-specific risks** — flood mapping, cyclone exposure, and insurance cost implications, which can materially affect both your ongoing costs and future resale value in parts of Queensland.

Section 3 — Setting Up for Compliance From Day One

- ☐ ☐ **Budget for Minimum Housing Standards compliance** if the property needs work to meet the mandatory categories (weatherproofing, locks, plumbing, window coverings, safe fixtures, functional kitchen/laundry) — factor this into your purchase budget.
- ☐ ☐ **Decide on self-management vs. a property manager** — QLD's compliance requirements (Form 22 applications, minimum housing standards, QCAT processes, bond rules) are genuinely complex for a self-managing landlord unfamiliar with the RTRA Act.
- ☐ ☐ **Arrange landlord insurance**, separate from standard building insurance.
- ☐ ☐ **Engage a quantity surveyor for a tax depreciation schedule** shortly after settlement — see the separate Tax & Depreciation Checklist in this series.

Section 4 — Understanding the Current Tax Environment

- ☐ ☐ **Be aware Commonwealth CGT settings for investment property are changing**, with reforms affecting the CGT discount generally applying from 1 July 2027 — confirm the finalised current position with your accountant.
- ☐ ☐ **Get advice on purchase and sale timing relative to this changeover** if your investment horizon spans the 2027 transition.

Quick Reference — QLD Investment Property Snapshot (July 2026)

ITEM	DETAIL
Land tax threshold (individuals)	\$600,000
Land tax threshold (companies/trusts)	\$350,000
Absentee owner surcharge	3% (stepped up from 2%)
Additional Foreign Acquirer Duty (AFAD)	7%, on top of standard transfer duty
Land tax foreign surcharge relief	New administrative exemption framework from 30 June 2026
Land tax assessment	Based on holdings at 30 June each year

Land tax and surcharge rates change with state budgets — always confirm current figures with the Queensland Revenue Office before settling on a purchase strategy.

